

Linux Command Line Cheat Sheet

Essential commands every student needs, organized by task.

Navigation

- `pwd` — show current directory
- `ls -la` — list all files with details
- `cd /path` — change directory
- `find / -name filename` — search for a file

Files & Directories

- `touch file.txt` — create an empty file
- `mkdir foldername` — create a directory
- `cp source dest` — copy a file
- `mv source dest` — move or rename a file
- `rm filename` — delete a file (`rm -r` for folders)

Viewing & Editing

- `cat file.txt` — print file contents
- `less file.txt` — view file page by page
- `nano file.txt` — simple text editor
- `grep 'text' file.txt` — search inside a file

Permissions

- `chmod 755 file` — set read/write/execute permissions
- `chown user:group file` — change file ownership
- `ls -l` — view permissions on files

System & Network

- `whoami` — show current user
- `ps aux` — list running processes
- `top` / `htop` — monitor system resources
- `ifconfig` / `ip a` — show network interfaces
- `ping host` — test network connectivity

Package Management (Debian/Kali)

- `sudo apt update` — refresh package list
- `sudo apt install packagename` — install software
- `sudo apt remove packagename` — uninstall software